Staff Substitution Improvement

Client Background

RecWell provides the University's recreational and wellness services and is housed at the main gym facility, Eppley Recreational Center.

Mission statement: To enrich the educational experience and encourage personal growth by inspiring the university community to be active and live well.

Structure: James Cecil, North Facilities Coordinator, oversees a staff of 55 students working in Eppley.

201

unclaimed shifts over 4 semesters

1/3

of staff unsatisfied with communication

Scope Overview

RecWell staff struggle to cover all the shifts posted by staff who cannot work their scheduled shift.

We analyzed the current substitution system to optimize the way staff find their shift replacement.

Student cannot make shift and posts online → Shift does not get picked up by other staff → Vacant positions in gym, causing disruption

Methodology

Step 1: Define
Staff of Eppley are dropping shifts without coverage leading to understaffed work days. We aimed better means of communication and a better support system.

Step 2: Measure
Surveyed staff about substitution satisfaction. Monitored number of shifts posted throughout the semester.

Step 3: Analyze
Identified correlation between number of employees and shifts posted per week. Assessed concentration of shifts posted vs. picked up.

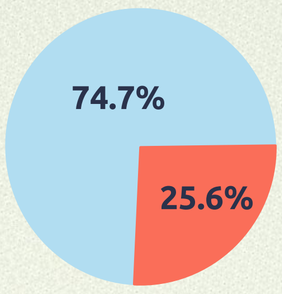
Step 4: Implement
Recommended more hires in future semesters. Suggested block for over-poster and noted benefits for grouping new staff in cohorts.

Step 5: Control
Monitor number of shifts posted vs. picked up in the upcoming fall semester with more new employees.

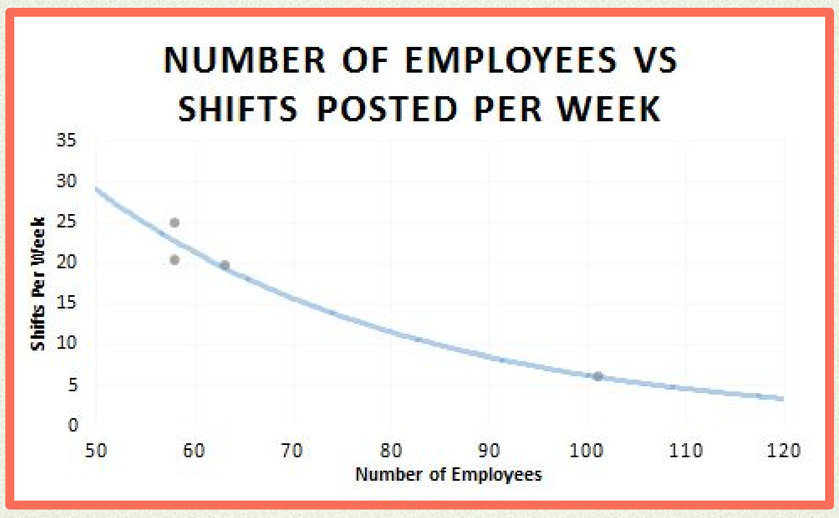
Key Data Analysis

Are you more likely to pick up a shift from someone you know?

(39 responses)



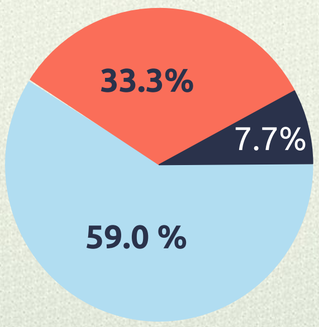
- More Likely to pick up a shift from someone I know
- Doesn't matter- equally as likely to pick up a shift from anyone



*"**8%** of employees account for **61%** of the problem"*

What is the main way you find out about an open shift?

(39 responses)



- Looking at the substitution log
- Group Chat
- Text or Call

Recommendations

Plus Minus System→ Affects scheduling
Edit the current scheduling system to favor staff with more shifts covered than posted.

SubItUp→ Schedule synced listserv
Staff will get a notification when a shift is available in a time slot of their availability.

Cohorts→ Enhances team dynamic
New hires will be placed on a cohort that will act as first responses for open shifts.

Hire More Staff → Less shifts posted
There is a strong correlation between number of staff and shifts posted per week.

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